

8.1 Security-Related Hacks

Secure Your Desktop Icons And Settings

Prevent your friends from playing with the desktop settings on your computer!

Navigate to:

HCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer

Here, create a DWORD Value called NoSaveSettings. Set its value to 1. You'll need to restart Windows for the change to take effect.

A Barren My Computer

To entirely prevent access to your drives, you *could* try hiding them. This hack disables the display of local and networked drives in My Computer.

Navigate to:

HCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer

In the right pane, create a new DWORD and name it NoDrives. Modify its value to 03ffffff (in hexadecimal). Press [F5] to refresh. Now when you click on My Computer, no drives will be shown. To re-enable the display of the drives, simply delete the DWORD you created.

No More Regedit!

This restriction removes the ability to run Microsoft Registry editing tools such as Regedit and REGEDT32. Be careful with this setting; once you enter the following key into the registry, you will not be able to use Regedit to undo the change! Be careful not to lock yourself out of the Registry: create a .reg file that will re-enable access to the registry editor. The file should have the value of DisableRegistryTools set to 1.